“If I say no, people will reject me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

If love was conditional in our family, or if saying no brought anger, sulking, or punishment, we learned that refusal is dangerous. As adults we say yes to avoid conflict, and then feel resentful, overextended, and unsure whether anyone likes us for who we are.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “Simply let your ‘Yes’ be ‘Yes,’ and your ‘No,’ ‘No.’” Paul writes, “Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God?” Proverbs says, “The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high.” Jesus “frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray,” and “early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up and slipped out to a solitary place to pray,” even when people wanted Him. A kind no is not a rejection of the person, and people who truly care will usually adjust.

> *“Simply let your ‘Yes’ be ‘Yes,’ and your ‘No,’ ‘No.’ Anything more comes from the evil one”* (Matthew 5:37).

Also see

> “Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ” (Galatians 1:10).

> “The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high” (Proverbs 29:25).

> “Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray” (Luke 5:16).

> “Early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up and slipped out to a solitary place to pray” (Mark 1:35).

Common self-statements

- If I say no, they will be angry or leave.
- I will lose my friends.
- Saying no is mean.
- I cannot disappoint anyone.
- People only like me when I say yes.
- Conflict will follow.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection if I say no.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how they will react.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining total loss after one refusal.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling anxious and concluding that no is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What happened when I said no growing up?
- When have I said no and the relationship survived?

- What does constant yes cost me?
- What is a kind, clear no that I could practice?
- Who would stay if I said no?
- What would God say about my need to please?

Truth summary

> A kind no is not a rejection. People who love me can handle my limits, and God does not ask me to please everyone. I can say no gently and clearly and trust God with the response.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Wisdom
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I say no, people will reject me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I say no, people will reject me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What happened when I said no?
- ☐ What does yes cost me?
- ☐ What is a kind no?
- ☐ Who would stay?
- ☐ What is God's view?
- ☐ What will I practice?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My yes can be yes and my no can be no.
- ☐ The fear of man is a snare.
- ☐ Jesus withdrew to pray.
- ☐ Healthy people accept limits.
- ☐ I can be kind and clear.
- ☐ I seek God's approval.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 5:37**
  "Simply let your 'Yes' be 'Yes,' and your 'No,' 'No.' Anything more comes from the evil one."
- ☐ **Galatians 1:10**
  "Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ."
- ☐ **Luke 5:16**
  "Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A kind no: Each week, record a no you said and how the relationship fared.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 5:37 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can let my yes be yes and my no be no.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Practice a script. Write: "Thank you for asking. I can't this time."
- ☐ Start small. Say no to a low-stakes request.
- ☐ Notice the result. Record what actually happened.
- ☐ Withdraw to pray. Take time alone to hear God.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I say no, people will reject me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A kind no
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I say no, people will reject me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear disappointing people. Teach me to be kind and clear, to say yes and no with honesty, and to rest in Your approval. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Setting boundaries is selfish.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many believers were taught to be selfless, to turn the other cheek, and to put others first. Those are good teachings, but they can be bent into the idea that having any limits is sinful. People who grew up caring for a troubled parent or sibling may have been told that their needs did not matter.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus “frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray,” and He did not heal everyone in every town. Proverbs says, “Guard your heart with all diligence, for from it flow springs of life,” and “Like a city whose walls are broken down is a man who does not control his temper.” Paul writes, “Each one should carry his own load.” Jesus said the second greatest commandment is to love your neighbor as yourself, which assumes some care for yourself. Boundaries are not walls to keep love out. They are fences that protect what is valuable, including your ability to love others well.

> *“Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray”* (Luke 5:16).

Also see

> “Early in the morning, while it was still dark, Jesus got up and slipped out to a solitary place to pray” (Mark 1:35).
>
> “Guard your heart with all diligence, for from it flow springs of life” (Proverbs 4:23).
>
> “Like a city whose walls are broken down is a man who does not control his temper” (Proverbs 25:28).
>
> “For each one should carry his own load” (Galatians 6:5).

Common self-statements

- Good Christians have no limits.
- Saying no is putting myself first.
- Selfless people never say no.
- I should always be available.
- Limits are unloving.
- My needs do not count.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either selfless or selfish.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should always be available.
- Labeling: Calling myself selfish for having limits.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that boundaries are wrong.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that limits are selfish?
- Did Jesus ever step away or say no?
- What happens to my love and patience when I have no limits?
- What is the difference between selfish and healthy?

- What boundary would help me love better?
- Who would benefit if I were rested and well?

Truth summary

> Boundaries are a way to steward my time, energy, and heart so I can love well. Jesus Himself withdrew to rest and pray. Healthy limits are not selfish. They help me serve without resentment.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Self-Sacrifice
- Tired
- Love, For Others
- Temptation

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Setting boundaries is selfish"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Setting boundaries is selfish." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn limits are selfish?
- ☐ What did Jesus do?
- ☐ What limit do I need?
- ☐ How will I say it?
- ☐ What will it allow?
- ☐ Who benefits?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus withdrew to pray.
- ☐ I am to guard my heart.
- ☐ Boundaries protect love.
- ☐ I carry my own load.
- ☐ Self-control is a virtue.
- ☐ Healthy limits help me serve.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 5:16
  "Yet He frequently withdrew to the wilderness to pray."
- ☐ Proverbs 4:23
  "Guard your heart with all diligence, for from it flow springs of life."
- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  "For each one should carry his own load."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A limit that helped: Each week, record a boundary you kept and what it allowed.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 5:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus withdrew to pray, so I can set healthy limits.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Sacrifice" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Define a boundary. Write one limit you need.
- [ ] Communicate it kindly. Explain it simply, without a long defense.
- [ ] Hold it gently. Repeat it calmly if tested.
- [ ] Rest and pray. Take time alone like Jesus did.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Setting boundaries is selfish": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A limit that helped
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Setting boundaries is selfish.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You withdrew to be with the Father. Teach me to guard my heart, set loving limits, and serve without resentment. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Conflict always ruins relationships.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

If conflict in our home meant screaming, silence for days, or violence, we learned to avoid it at all costs. Some churches also teach that disagreement is a lack of unity. The result is surface peace and hidden resentment, and relationships that cannot handle honesty.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus taught, “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over.” Paul says, “Speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ.” Proverbs says, “Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful,” and “the tongue of the wise brings healing.” Jesus said, “First go and be reconciled to your brother.” Handled well, conflict can strengthen relationships. Avoiding it can quietly erode them.

> *“Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful”* (Proverbs 27:5–6).

Also see

> “If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over” (Matthew 18:15).

> “Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head” (Ephesians 4:15).

> “Speaking rashly is like a piercing sword, but the tongue of the wise brings healing” (Proverbs 12:18).

> “So if you are offering your gift at the altar and there remember that your brother has something against you, leave your gift there before the altar. First go and be reconciled to your brother; then come and offer your gift” (Matthew 5:23–24).

Common self-statements

- If we disagree, it is over.
- Peace means never arguing.
- I must avoid conflict at all costs.
- If I bring it up, it will explode.
- Good relationships have no conflict.
- Silence is safer.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Imagining that any conflict will destroy the relationship.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing relationships are either conflict-free or broken.
- Fortune telling: Predicting an explosion.
- Should statements: Insisting that good relationships should have no tension.

Challenging questions

- What did conflict look like in my family?
- Have I seen a disagreement handled well? What made the difference?
- What do I lose by avoiding hard conversations?
- What would a calm, respectful way of raising an issue look like?
- What does Scripture say about speaking the truth in love?
- Is any conflict in my life unsafe, requiring outside help?

Truth summary

> Conflict handled with respect can strengthen relationships. I can speak the truth in love, listen, and work toward reconciliation. Where conflict is unsafe, I can seek help and protect myself.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Communication
- Argumentative
- Anger
- Peace
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Communication
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Conflict always ruins relationships"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Conflict always ruins relationships." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did conflict look like at home?
- ☐ What have I seen done well?
- ☐ What does avoiding cost?
- ☐ How can I raise an issue gently?
- ☐ Is it safe?
- ☐ Who can help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The wounds of a friend are faithful.
- ☐ I can speak the truth in love.
- ☐ Reconciliation is possible.
- ☐ The tongue of the wise brings healing.
- ☐ Avoidance has costs.
- ☐ I can seek help if it is unsafe.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 27:5–6**
  "Better an open rebuke than love that is concealed. The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful."
- ☐ **Matthew 18:15**
  "If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over."
- ☐ **Ephesians 4:15**
  "Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into Christ Himself, who is the head."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Truth in love: Each week, note one issue you raised respectfully and what happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ephesians 4:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can speak the truth in love.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Communication" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Choose a small issue. Practice on a low-stakes topic.
- [ ] Use a gentle start. Begin with "I feel... when... I would like..."
- [ ] Listen first. Ask the other person to share their view.
- [ ] Seek help if needed. If conflict involves threats or violence, call 911 or seek counseling.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Conflict always ruins relationships": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Truth in love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Conflict always ruins relationships.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, conflict frightens me. Teach me to speak the truth in love, to listen well, and to seek reconciliation. Protect me where it is unsafe. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I must give people whatever they ask of me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Generous people, caregivers, and helpers can be asked for time, money, rides, listening, and favors without end. If we were raised to think that refusing a request is unloving, we can end up drained and used. Some of us also feel that if someone is in need, we are automatically responsible.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes of giving, “Each one should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver.” He also says, “Each one should carry his own load.” Proverbs notes, “The prudent man watches his steps.” Jesus said, “Let your ‘Yes’ be ‘Yes,’ and your ‘No,’ ‘No.’” Giving is a gift of the heart. It is not a duty to anyone who asks. We are called to love, and love uses wisdom: sometimes it gives, sometimes it says no, and sometimes it points to other resources.

> *“Each one should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver”* (2 Corinthians 9:7).

Also see

> “For each one should carry his own load” (Galatians 6:5).

> “The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps” (Proverbs 14:15).

> “Simply let your ‘Yes’ be ‘Yes,’ and your ‘No,’ ‘No.’ Anything more comes from the evil one” (Matthew 5:37).

> “Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ” (Galatians 1:10).

Common self-statements

- If someone asks, I have to say yes.
- I cannot say no to people in need.
- Refusing is unloving.
- I must meet every request.
- If I do not help, no one will.
- I owe everyone my time.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I must meet every request.
- Personalization: Treating every need as my responsibility.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must give everything or nothing.
- Magnification: Treating a refusal as cruelty.

Challenging questions

- What do people ask of me that leaves me resentful?
- Do I give out of cheerful choice or compulsion?

- What are my real limits in time, money, and energy?
- What are other resources the person could use?
- How can I say no with kindness?
- What would giving freely look like?

Truth summary

> I am free to decide what I give. God loves a cheerful giver, not a compelled one. I can say yes with joy when I can, say no with kindness when I cannot, and trust God to care for those I cannot help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Giving
- Servant
- Wisdom
- Tired
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must give people whatever they ask of me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must give people whatever they ask of me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What requests drain me?
- ☐ Do I give gladly or by compulsion?
- ☐ What are my limits?
- ☐ What other resources exist?
- ☐ How can I say no kindly?
- ☐ What can I give freely?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God loves a cheerful giver.
- ☐ I decide in my heart what to give.
- ☐ Compulsion is not love.
- ☐ I carry my own load.
- ☐ The prudent watch their steps.
- ☐ I can trust God with others' needs.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 9:7
  "Each one should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not out of regret or compulsion. For God loves a cheerful giver."
- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  "For each one should carry his own load."
- ☐ Matthew 5:37
  "Simply let your 'Yes' be 'Yes,' and your 'No,' 'No.' Anything more comes from the evil one."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Chosen giving: Each week, record one thing you gave gladly and one request you declined kindly.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 2 Corinthians 9:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I decide in my heart what to give, and God loves a cheerful giver.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Giving" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List the drains. Write the requests that leave you resentful.
- ☐ Define your limits. Decide what you can give in time and money.
- ☐ Practice a response. Write, "I can't, but I hope you find help."
- ☐ Give gladly. Choose one thing to give freely this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must give people whatever they ask of me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Chosen giving
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must give people whatever they ask of me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I want to be generous, but I am worn out. Teach me to give freely and wisely, to say no kindly, and to trust You with the needs I cannot meet. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“A good Christian never gets angry.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many of us learned that anger is always sinful, that nice people never show it, and that Christians should be calm. Where anger was explosive in the home, we may fear it in ourselves. So we bury it, and it comes out as sarcasm, withdrawal, headaches, or a sudden blowup.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, “Be angry, yet do not sin. Do not let the sun set upon your anger,” which assumes anger is not itself sin. The psalmist says, “Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still.” Jesus “looked around at them with anger and sorrow at their hardness of heart,” and He made a whip and drove the money changers out of the temple. James says, “Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man’s anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires.” Proverbs says, “A gentle answer turns away wrath.” Anger is a signal. What we do with it matters.

> *“‘Be angry, yet do not sin.’ Do not let the sun set upon your anger, and do not give the devil a foothold”* (Ephesians 4:26–27).

Also see

> “Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still” (Psalm 4:4).

> “Jesus looked around at them with anger and sorrow at their hardness of heart. Then He said to the man, ‘Stretch out your hand.’ So he stretched it out, and it was restored” (Mark 3:5).

> “My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man’s anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires” (James 1:19–20).

> “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger” (Proverbs 15:1).

Common self-statements

- Angry feelings mean I am a bad Christian.
- I should never feel this way.
- Good people stay calm.
- If I get angry, I am sinning.
- I have to bury my anger.
- Anger is always wrong.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing anger is either absent or sinful.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never feel anger.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty about anger and concluding that I am bad.
- Suppression: Burying anger, which then leaks out sideways.

Challenging questions

- What was I taught about anger, and by whom?

- What does my anger tell me about what I value or what hurt me?
- Did Jesus ever express anger? What was its source and its limit?
- What are healthy ways to express anger?
- What happens when I bury it?
- What can I do tonight to search my heart and be still?

Truth summary

> Anger itself is not a sin. It is a signal that something matters to me or has hurt me. I can bring it to God, express it respectfully, and not let it control me. Jesus felt anger too, and He never sinned.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anger
- Communication
- Impatient
- Peace
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anger
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "A good Christian never gets angry"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"A good Christian never gets angry." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was I taught about anger?
- ☐ What is my anger telling me?
- ☐ How did Jesus express anger?
- ☐ What healthy outlets do I have?
- ☐ What happens when I bury it?
- ☐ Whom can I talk with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Be angry, yet do not sin.
- ☐ Jesus felt anger.
- ☐ Anger is a signal.
- ☐ I can bring anger to God.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ I can express anger without harming.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Ephesians 4:26–27**
  "'Be angry, yet do not sin.' Do not let the sun set upon your anger, and do not give the devil a foothold."
- ☐ **Psalm 4:4**
  "Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still."
- ☐ **Proverbs 15:1**
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
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  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Anger as a signal: Each time you feel anger, write what hurt or mattered, and one healthy response.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Ephesians 4:26–27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can be angry without sinning when I bring it to God.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anger" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the anger. Write what you are angry about and what it protects.
- ☐ Bring it to God. Pray it out honestly, using the psalms as a model.
- ☐ Take a pause. Walk, breathe, or journal before responding.
- ☐ Speak calmly. Share your concern respectfully with the person involved.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "A good Christian never gets angry": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

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Thu				
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Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~A good Christian never gets angry.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have been afraid of my anger. Help me hear what it is telling me, bring it to You honestly, and respond in ways that heal rather than harm. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.